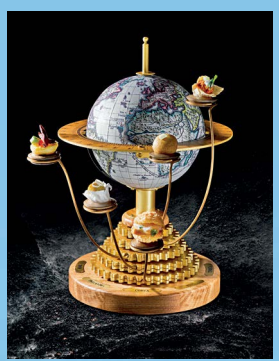
FOOD & DRINK
HOSPITALITY

ESPERIT ROCA, GIRONA , SPAIN

If Girona feels like the setting of a medieval fantasy, it's probably because it is. Winding through the Barri Vell (Old Town) feels like flipping through history's scrapbook, while the kaleidoscopic houses lining the Onyar River seem to be painted with an artist's wild dream. But what's on the plate, is what makes Castell de Sant Julia so special. Situated just outside the city, this 19th century fortress turned hideaway is the culinary masterpiece of the Roca brothers (of El Celler de Can Roca fame). It whispers history through its aged stones, but the real magic happens on the plate, where Michelin level brilliance meets history. With six savoury dishes and two desserts or, get this, two main courses followed by six desserts, the hotel's Esperit Roca Restaurant transforms the palate into the protagonist of a sensory tale. Jordi Roca, the mad genius of pastry and whimsy, created these dishes, which feel like edible fairy tales. Jordi Roca, the pastry sorcerer of Netflix's 'Chef's Table' fame, leads the sweeter path, creating confections like cakes that dissolve into aromatic elixirs, pushing the boundaries of pastry. Highlights? Start with 'Bosque lluvioso (Rainy Forest)', a dessert inspired by Jordi's daily walks through damp woods. Then there's the cake, weightless, gravity defying, finished with an aromatic drizzle that ties every bite together. Savoury lovers find much to swoon over with dishes such as the 'All the Prawn,' a Palamós prawn odyssey topped with seaweed vinegar, crispy prawn legs, and velvety prawn distillate. Or the decadent poularde brioche with truffle and foie gras. The dream doesn't have to end the morning after where Roca breakfasts simply seal the deal. This culinary escape is one that is well worth every mile travelled.

Where Carrer Major, Entrada 1, 17481 Sant Julià de Ramis, Girona, Spain
Contact https://hotelesperitroca.com/en/
Must Do A tour of the Hotel's Culinary Museum, Kitchen and cellar.





Top to bottom: Breakfast Table set up at the Hotel's restaurant; The menu begins with a journey around the world at Restaurant Esperit Roca; Exterior of the 19th century fortress turned hideaway is a warren of foodie treasures

